

Nikita Sokolsky

Senior Software Engineer · Distributed systems, high-scale AWS infrastructure, AI-assisted development · 15 years of experience

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US Green Card holder, no sponsorship required · open to relocation anywhere in the US

On a planned break since Apr 2026 · available immediately

Summary

Backend and distributed systems engineer, 15 years in the industry and 8 at Amazon and AWS. Core engineer on the data store that every Alexa device in the world reads from at over 100,000 TPS, including the work that let Alexa+ ship, and before that two years in the AWS WAF request path. Java, Rust, Go and Scala, plus LLM-assisted development since mid-2022.

Experience

Amazon Web Services, Alexa AI · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer II, Alexa Device Intelligence · Nov 2024 – Apr 2026 · Java, DynamoDB, Kinesis, Lambda

- Core engineer on the DynamoDB-backed store behind every Alexa device worldwide: device state, configuration and session data for hundreds of millions of endpoints at over 100,000 TPS.
- Scaled the data layer for the Alexa+ launch, Amazon's generative-AI Alexa, and reworked access patterns to take hot-partition risk out of the peak device-traffic path.

Amazon Web Services, AWS WAF · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer II · Nov 2022 – Nov 2024 · Java, Rust, Kafka, Kinesis

- Halved p50 latency in the request-processing pipeline that enforces customer security rules on billions of HTTP requests a day across every AWS region.
- Brought Rust into the hot path of the rule-evaluation engine to replace Java bottlenecks. Fleet size for the service dropped to a third.

Flexport · Seattle, WA

Senior Software Engineer, Freight Forwarding Platform · Feb 2022 – Nov 2022 · Scala, PostgreSQL, React

- Led design and delivery of the freight forwarding application that more than 2,000 cargo operators work in daily, replacing a legacy monolith with event-driven Scala services.

Amazon Web Services, Networking · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer · May 2021 – Feb 2022 · Go, ECS, Lambda

- One of the first engineers on the service that shipped as [Amazon CloudWatch Internet Monitor](#), from scoping and system design through the internal launch review.

Amazon, Business Payments and Business Credit · Seattle, WA and Vancouver, BC

Software Development Engineer · Jan 2018 – May 2021 · Java, Spring, React

- Split a brittle monolithic invoice pipeline for Amazon Business into independently deployable services, and delivered the Amazon Business credit card with American Express on schedule in 2018.

Earlier · 2011 – 2018

Developer and consultant in Prague, Munich and London: C#/.NET enterprise platforms, Dynamics CRM integrations and AngularJS frontends.

Technical skills

- **Languages:** Java, Rust, Go, Scala, TypeScript, C#/.NET, SQL
- **AWS and data:** DynamoDB, Kinesis, MSK (Kafka), Lambda, EC2, ECS, S3, RDS, CloudWatch, PostgreSQL
- **Systems:** Distributed systems, event-driven architecture, stream processing, capacity planning, load shedding, on-call operations, observability
- **AI:** LLM-assisted and agentic development (Cursor + custom harnesses), MCP tooling, RAG, prompt engineering

Projects, recognition and education

- sokolsky.me · personal SaaS: custom flight and hotel search engines, 90 pages in ten weeks with coding agents.
- rankmyweather.com · ranks world cities by how the weather feels outdoors, from five years of ERA5 reanalysis data.
- **Amazon Bar Raiser** · certified to hold Amazon's hiring bar, 200+ interviews, 5 years mentoring junior engineers.
- **M.Sc. Artificial Intelligence** and **B.Sc. Computer Software Engineering** · Czech Technical University, Prague · 2011 – 2017